



Mark Scheme (Results)

November 2025

Pearson Edexcel International GCSE
in English Literature (4ET1/02)

Paper 2: Modern Drama and Literary Heritage Texts

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General Marking Guidance

- All candidates must receive the same treatment. Examiners must mark the first candidate in exactly the same way as they mark the last.
- Mark schemes should be applied positively. Candidates must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than penalised for omissions.
- Examiners should mark according to the mark scheme not according to their perception of where the grade boundaries may lie.
- There is no ceiling on achievement. All marks on the mark scheme should be used appropriately.
- All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded. Examiners should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the answer matches the mark scheme. Examiners should also be prepared to award zero marks if the candidate's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme.
- Where some judgement is required, mark schemes will provide the principles by which marks will be awarded and exemplification may be limited.
- When examiners are in doubt regarding the application of the mark scheme to a candidate's response, the team leader must be consulted.
- Crossed out work should be marked UNLESS the candidate has replaced it with an alternative response.

Specific Marking Guidance

- When deciding how to reward an answer, examiners should consult both the indicative content and the associated marking grid(s). When using a levels-based mark scheme, the 'best fit' approach should be used.
- Examiners should first decide which descriptor most closely matches the answer and place it in that level.
- The mark awarded within the level will be decided based on the quality of the answer and will be modified according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level.
- Indicative content is exactly that – they are factual points that candidates are likely to use to construct their answer.
- It is possible for an answer to be constructed without mentioning some or all of these points, as long as they provide alternative responses to the indicative content that fulfils the requirements of the question. It is the examiner's responsibility to apply their professional judgement to the candidate's response in determining if the answer fulfils the requirements of the question.

Placing a mark within a level

- Examiners should first decide which descriptor most closely matches the answer and place it in that level. The mark awarded within the level will be decided based on the quality of the answer and will be modified according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level.
- In cases of uneven performance, the points above will still apply. Candidates will be placed in the level that best describes their answer according to the descriptors in that level. Marks will be awarded towards the top or bottom of that level depending on how they have evidenced each of the descriptor bullet points.
- If the candidate's answer meets the requirements fully, markers should be prepared to award full marks within the level. The top mark in the level is used for work that is as good as can realistically be expected within that level.

AO1	Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement.
AO2	Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects.
AO4	Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written.

SECTION A – Modern Drama

Question number	Indicative content
1 <i>A View from the Bridge</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to agree or disagree, wholly or in part, with the view that the ending of the play is successful. Responses should be judged on the quality of the argument presented • it could be argued that the ending is successful as it is Eddie's own knife that he is stabbed with. This is very significant and symbolises the theme of Eddie's own personal responsibility in his demise. He is the one who, earlier in the play, is destructively possessive of his niece, Catherine. He is the author of his own ostracism from the community and his family by calling the Immigration Bureau to report Marco and Rodolpho. It is Eddie himself who brings a knife to the duel with Marco • the ending could also be deemed successful because, in Marco's attack and the death of Eddie, a kind of primitive power balance is restored and Marco's all-important honour is returned to him. However, in contrast, Eddie's honour is not restored. Eddie's attack on Marco by reporting him to the authorities is balanced out by his defeat in the duel at the end of the play's action • the violence of the ending successfully draws to a climax themes of conflict and bitterness that build during the play's development. The incidents involving the chair's being lifted and Eddie's attempt to kiss Rodolpho to prove his sexuality foreshadow the play's violent ending • the ending could also be considered successful because Eddie's death reunites him with his wife. It is significant that he dies in the arms of Beatrice and he shows his true feelings in his dying words: 'My B!' The enduring love of a long-standing marriage triumphs over the obsession and infatuation of his interest in Catherine. However, it could be argued that the ending of the play is not successful because their reunion comes too late and Beatrice is widowed • the ending of the play highlights the theme of forgiveness when Rodolpho apologises to Eddie on the day of his wedding to Catherine, trying to reconcile himself to his old adversary. Even though Eddie has treated him and his brother badly, he reaches out to kiss Eddie's hand. He is about to become an American through this marriage and, by association, will become part of the Carbone family • Eddie's dramatic confrontation with Marco, which sees him try to demand an apology for the loss of his good name, could also be considered to contribute to the successful end of the play. The conclusion successfully disproves the existence of an ultimate, overarching law. The play ends with what remains of Eddie's honour lying in tatters

- it could be argued that the ending of the play is not successful, or as dramatic as it might be, because, through Alfieri, the audience possibly knows the outcome from the start. However, it could also be argued that the dramatic tension is maintained in learning how events unfold. Alfieri wisely reflects 'I could see every step coming, step after step, like a dark figure walking down a hall towards a certain door'.

(AO2)

- Language/Structure: at the start of the play, Alfieri foreshadows Eddie's downfall: 'another lawyer, quite differently dressed, heard the same complaint and sat there as powerless as I, and watched it run its bloody course'. Alfieri knows that he can do nothing to stop the 'bloody course' that is to unfold
- Language/Structure: by the end of the play, Catherine and Rodolpho are married. Although Eddie questions the sincerity of Rodolpho's love for Catherine, Rodolpho demonstrates his true feelings through romantic imagery: 'tell yourself, please, that I am not a beggar, and you are not a horse, a gift, a favour for a poor immigrant'
- Form/Structure: before the play reaches its climax, the stage directions introduce the knife; this indicates to the audience how Eddie will meet his demise: '*Eddie springs a knife into his hand*'
- Form/Structure: Eddie portrays the role of the tragic hero; his death at the end of the play is inevitable
- Structure: the ending of the play successfully demonstrates the resilience of the love between Beatrice and Eddie.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
2 <i>A View from the Bridge</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • at the start of the play, Eddie Carbone is presented as a traditional, hard-working man who enjoys the respect of the local Red Hook community. However, by the end of the play, Eddie loses all respect and, ultimately, his life • when Eddie first learns of the imminent arrival of both Marco and Rodolpho, he shows empathy. He is supportive of Beatrice and is pleased that he is able to help the men, particularly as his father was also an immigrant from Italy • towards the beginning of the play, Eddie nicknames Catherine 'Madonna', symbolising his perception of her as innocent and pure. However, even at this point, Eddie is protective of Catherine and is reluctant to allow her to get a job where she might encounter other men. Later in the play, Eddie refers to Catherine as 'Garbo', a sexual icon, showing his increasingly apparent incestuous feelings • it becomes apparent that Eddie's feelings for Catherine have impacted on his relationship with his wife and he no longer shows her any affection. Beatrice asks Eddie 'When am I gonna be a wife again, Eddie?' Beatrice also warns Catherine that she is now a grown woman and should not behave in the same way towards Eddie: 'I told you fifty times already, you can't act the way you act. You still walk around in front of him in your slip –' • following Rodolpho's rendition of 'Paper Doll' in the Carbone's apartment, Eddie offers friendly advice to him: 'Look, kid; you don't want to be picked up, do ya?', warning him against behaviour that will draw attention to them. However, there are early signs of some distance in the relationship between Eddie and Rodolpho, with the stage directions showing how Eddie <i>'is coming more and more to address Marco only'</i> • Eddie's growing jealousy of the relationship between Catherine and Rodolpho is apparent in his heightened anger: <i>'his eyes were like tunnels'</i>. He attempts to humiliate Rodolpho and deliberately hurts him whilst 'teaching' him to box. The stage directions depict how Rodolpho <i>'staggers'</i> as a result of Eddie's violent blows • early in the play, Eddie shows a steadfast loyalty to the Italian code of honour. Following the story of 'snitch' Vinny Bolzano, Eddie questions how 'a guy do a thing like that? How's he gonna show his face?' • however, as the play progresses, Eddie visits Alfieri with concerns about the relationship between Rodolpho and Catherine. Alfieri advises Eddie 'You have no recourse in the law'. Eddie stubbornly refuses to listen to Alfieri's warnings against taking things into his own hands, and Eddie's jealousy and anger culminate in his reporting of Marco and Rodolpho to the Immigration Bureau. This is significant as it marks the end of his previously unfaltering devotion to the Italian code of honour and marks a point of no return for the tragic protagonist

- by the end of the play, Eddie has lost everything. Catherine has called him 'a rat' and he is alienated from the community. Marco confronts him, which leads to his violent demise
- Eddie's last words, 'My B!', show how he ultimately seeks comfort in Beatrice. The audience is left to speculate whether Eddie's love for Beatrice was ever in doubt.

(A02)

- Language: early in the play, Eddie has a role as provider and protector. He treats Catherine like a young child but appears to mean well: 'I'm responsible for you. You're a baby, you don't understand these things'
- Language: Eddie is portrayed as an honourable man in the first part of the play. He remarks that he 'walked hungry plenty days in this city!' showing that he has engaged in honest struggle to reach his current, secure position
- Language: Eddie's decline is evident in his increasingly desperate language. He exclaims: 'I want my name! He didn't take my name; he's a punk'. The word 'punk' is offensive and derogatory
- Form: Eddie acts in an increasingly forceful manner towards Catherine. The stage directions show how Eddie '*grabs her arm*' when he returns home drunk to find her with Rodolpho. Eddie attempts to control Catherine physically, which is perhaps the only way he can now
- Form/Structure: later in the play, Eddie shows some signs that he is aware that his behaviour has spiralled out of control. Immediately after Eddie kisses Catherine and then Rodolpho, Eddie is described as standing '*with tears rolling down his face as he laughs mockingly at Rodolpho*'
- Form/Structure: in this genre of play, a tragic protagonist would typically speak in a soliloquy to share inner thoughts and feelings with the audience. Eddie does not do so; he finds it difficult to express his emotions at any time in the play.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
3 <i>An Inspector Calls</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to choose any character they admire in the play. They are likely to opt for the Inspector, Eva/Daisy, Sheila, Eric or even Gerald. However, any choice can be rewarded based on the argument presented • the Inspector plays a central role in the play, masterfully uncovering secrets from each of the characters. His direct approach to questioning, taking the form of 'one line of enquiry at a time', successfully reveals the family's involvement in Eva's/Daisy's fate and the cracks in their relationships • Inspector Goole tries to make the Birlings and Gerald aware of their responsibilities, and he attempts to activate their consciences. He warns of the apocalyptic future for humanity if his lessons are not heeded: 'We are responsible for each other. And I tell you that the time will soon come when, if men will not learn that lesson, then they will be taught it in fire and blood and anguish' • Eva/Daisy could be considered an admirable character because she is clearly a determined, hard-working woman. She is one of the strike leaders at Mr Birling's factory. After she is sacked from there, she moves on to work at Milwards • after meeting Eric, Eva/Daisy becomes pregnant. She admirably refuses to take money from Eric, aware that the money is stolen • Sheila may be deemed admirable because, when the Inspector arrives, she is moved by the fate of Eva/Daisy, as the story is told. The revelations of Inspector Goole prompt her to question her own actions and those of her family, and she is able to learn from her mistakes • Sheila's upset becomes anger with her parents over their lack of responsibility and compassion: 'But that's not what I'm talking about. I don't care about that. The point is you don't seem to have learnt anything' • Sheila works out the truth about Gerald and the reality of their relationship when it is revealed that he knew Eva/Daisy. She shows maturity in dealing with Gerald's dishonesty • towards the end of the play, Sheila becomes the ally of Inspector Goole and Priestley himself, helping to convey their message of social justice: 'Between us we drove that girl to commit suicide' • Eric could be considered admirable because of his growing social conscience and moral awareness. When he learns of the reasons why his father sacked Eva/Daisy, he questions the decision, 'Why shouldn't they try for higher wages?', although he does ignore the fact that he has benefitted from the profits of his father's business in his comfortable lifestyle • Eric can be seen to take some responsibility in that he offers to marry Eva/Daisy. He tries to support her financially, requesting a pay rise from his father. He only resorts to theft from the firm when his request is denied, taking practical steps to try to help her

- candidates might choose Gerald as the character they admire in the play. Although he cheats on Sheila, he does rescue Eva/Daisy from Alderman Meggarty and helps her with accommodation; he treats her well while they are together and is generous on parting. Following the Inspector's interrogation, Gerald is the sensible one who notices they are each shown Eva's/Daisy's photograph separately and thinks of checking with the Infirmary. It could be argued that he is the product of the expectations of males at the time, but he is not bad at heart.

(AO2)

- Language: when Sheila discovers the outcome of her complaint to Milwards about Eva/Daisy, the repetition of the adverb 'never' emphasises how apologetic she is for her behaviour: 'I'll never, never do it again'
- Language/Structure: towards the end of the play, Eric's language is increasingly rebellious, which the audience could consider admirable. Horrified at his parents' irresponsible and uncaring attitudes, he turns on them: 'I'm ashamed of you'. He makes it clear who is responsible for Eva's/Daisy's demise, showing increased independence and strength of character when he accuses Mr Birling: 'You're the one I blame for this'
- Language/Structure: the Inspector's didactic warning towards the end of the play has the tone of a sermon. The imagery of hell conveys its gravity: 'fire and blood and anguish'
- Language/Structure: by the end of the play, Sheila echoes the Inspector's words, showing how far she has come since the beginning: 'Fire and blood and anguish. And it frightens me the way you talk'
- Form/Structure: the moral redemption of Sheila and Eric offers some hope in the play as Priestley suggests there may be a sign that the younger generation will be harbingers of social justice.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
4 <i>An Inspector Calls</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the Inspector's interrogation of the Birlings and Gerald Croft exposes how they have taken advantage of others, particularly those in the working class. The play is set in 1912, a time when society was severely divided by class - the play opens on the evening of the announcement of the engagement of Gerald and Sheila. Despite being the time of the couple's celebration, the conversation is dominated by Sheila's boastful father, Mr Birling, who is trying to take advantage of the situation by impressing Gerald and securing 'lower costs and higher prices' by working with the Crofts - the Inspector can be seen as a voice for working-class people. He interrogates the Birlings and Gerald over their treatment, and exploitation, of Eva/Daisy and, by extension, the working class in general - Mr Birling sees his employees as nothing more than resources that he wants to take advantage of, as they are 'cheap labour' to him. The Inspector values the rights of employees and refers to the plight of the many people across the country who have to work for a living - the lack of legal protection for workers, and the severe implications of this, is exemplified by the fact that Eva/Daisy was sacked simply for protesting against low pay and asking for a rise. Mr Birling tells the Inspector: 'we were paying the usual rates and if they didn't like those rates, they could go and work somewhere else' - however, Eric does speak up in the workers' defence: 'Why shouldn't they try for higher wages? We try for the highest possible prices', apparently unaware of the irony that it is the workers' low wages that enable his comfortable way of life - Sheila takes advantage of her position as a valued customer of Milwards to complain about Eva's/Daisy's impertinence, causing her to be sacked. She confesses to the Inspector: 'I went to the manager at Milwards and I told him that if they didn't get rid of that girl, I'd never go near the place again and I'd persuade mother to close our account with them' - following Eva's/Daisy's dismissal from Milwards, both Gerald and Eric take advantage of Eva's/Daisy's reduced circumstances, albeit in different ways. Their behaviour towards her reinforces the idea that women of Eva's/Daisy's class could be used by the wealthy and then discarded - ironically, Eva/Daisy has been 'rescued' from the clutches of Alderman Meggarty by Gerald, only to be exploited by him in a less obvious and immediate way. He reveals how Eva/Daisy became his mistress because 'she was young and pretty and warm-hearted', which suggests that Gerald merely used her for his own gratification. Gerald ended the affair when it became inconvenient for him, 'I had to go away for several weeks then – on business', and he appears to have paid her off without a second thought: 'I insisted on Daisy moving into these rooms and I made her take some money'

- when Eric is questioned by the Inspector, he reveals how he forced Eva/Daisy into a sexual relationship: 'I was in that state when a chap easily turns nasty'. Later, Eric reveals how he did what he thought was right, not necessarily what Eva/Daisy wanted, to take responsibility for his actions, such as by offering to marry her
- the Inspector's direct questioning of the family takes the form of 'one line of enquiry at a time'. He tries to make the Birlings and Gerald aware of their responsibilities to those in less fortunate positions than themselves, and he attempts to activate their consciences. He warns of the apocalyptic future for humanity if his lessons are not heeded: 'We are responsible for each other. And I tell you that the time will soon come when, if men will not learn that lesson, then they will be taught it in fire and blood and anguish'.

(A02)

- Language: Mr Birling uses hyperbole to imply that his workers are unreasonably asking for far too much pay: 'If you don't come down sharply on some of these people, they'd soon be asking for the earth'
- Language: the Inspector uses an extended metaphor to convey how working-class people are taken advantage of by selfish capitalists: 'there are millions and millions of Eva Smiths and John Smiths'
- Language/Form: the Inspector uses first-person plural to emphasise the communal responsibility of all people for social justice. His words, 'We are members of one body ...', drive home Priestley's message that we must all act fairly and responsibly for the good of every member of humanity, regardless of class
- Form/Structure: the Inspector is Priestley's mouthpiece throughout the play, through whom he comments on, and condemns, social injustice
- Structure: the ambiguous ending leaves the audience to decide whether the family will start to consider how their actions impact on others and on each other, and not just pursue their own self-interests to strengthen their image in society.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
5 <i>The Curious Incident of the Dog in the Night-time</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to agree or disagree, wholly or in part, with the view that Christopher is presented as independent in the play. Responses should be judged on the quality of the argument presented • when the play opens, Christopher, a 15-year-old boy with autism, is seen to struggle with living his day-to-day life. He is dependent on his father, Ed Boone, who cares for him at home, and on his teacher, Siobhan, at school • although he is somewhat reliant on Siobhan, she does help Christopher to become more independent. For instance, Christopher often struggles to interpret the meaning of different facial expressions. Siobhan draws out examples for Christopher, which he refers to when he needs to understand how people are feeling • upon his discovery of Wellington's body, Christopher pledges to find out who murdered him. Christopher becomes increasingly independent as he has to interview people he does not know as part of his investigation – a situation he would ordinarily find very difficult. He talks with Mrs Shears, Mrs Alexander and Reverend Peters • Christopher pursues his investigation, contravening his father's express wishes for him not to. This in itself shows Christopher's yearning for independence, going against his father's orders. Ed is incensed when he finds out that Christopher has disobeyed him: 'How many times do I have to tell you, Christopher? I told you to keep your nose out of other people's business' • when Christopher later discovers the truth about his mother, Judy Boone, he decides to travel to London in search of her. He shows his growing independence when he thinks first of having his pet rat cared for and tries to leave him with Mrs Alexander: 'Can you look after Toby for me?' Christopher speaks practically to Mrs Alexander about Toby's needs: 'He eats special pellets and you can buy them from a pet shop' • in travelling to London, Christopher has to be independent. He uses his father's bank card to pay for his ticket and has to negotiate the rail and tube system. However, his ability to be independent is brought into question when, at one point, he risks his life down on the tube tracks to rescue Toby, unaware of the danger he is in • when Christopher returns from London, it is Siobhan who has to help Christopher in determining what he wants to do and if he is in a position to complete the Maths papers: 'How's your brain when you think about Maths?' • at the end of the play, Christopher appears optimistic for his future, particularly as a result of his becoming more independent: 'And I know I can do this because I went to London, and because I solved the mystery'. Nevertheless, Christopher still seeks some reassurance from Siobhan: 'Does that mean I can do anything, Siobhan?'

(A02)

- Language: on his journey to London, Christopher hears his father's voice in his head. He shows a determination to get to London independently, commanding his father 'Get away from me'
- Language/Form: however, it could be argued that Christopher's reliance on Siobhan means that he is not truly independent in the play. For example, Siobhan concisely breaks down instructions for Christopher using familiar vocabulary when he hears her as a soothing voice in his head
- Language/Form/Structure: the play has an unusual ending after the action has finished: '*After the curtain call Christopher returns to the stage*'. Christopher demonstrates his independence when he explains how he was able to solve the difficult Maths question, ending with a flourish: 'Quod. Erat. Demonstrandum'
- Form: the play can be considered a dramatic bildungsroman as Christopher comes of age during its action
- Structure: there is a change in Christopher's character when he discovers the body of Wellington. It forces him to come out of his comfort zone and it marks the start of his journey to independence.

Level	Mark	A01 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) A02 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
6 <i>The Curious Incident of the Dog in the Night-time</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - family is shown to be significant in this play. Christopher lives with his father, Ed Boone, who takes care of him by himself after Christopher's mother, Judy Boone, has left to live with Roger Shears. The two contrast as parents, but, while Judy leaves partly as a result of the challenge of being Christopher's mother, Ed muddles along, realising that he is not perfect but doing his best for his son - Ed provides Christopher with a stable family life. Christopher is a 15-year-old boy with autism, and his father shows an understanding of how best to communicate and support his son. For example, they share a touching scene when Ed spreads his fingers into a fan, which Christopher mirrors - although Ed has lied to his son when saying that his mother has died, his decision to do so comes from desperation and his desire to protect his son from feeling hurt - the audience and Christopher discover the truth about Judy when he finds letters that she has sent to him that have been hidden by Ed. In the letters, she praises Ed for being a good, caring father to Christopher, who is more able to cope with him, supporting the idea that Ed provides Christopher with stability in his life - Judy's letters are significant, as they indicate how she gave up as a mother, recognising her own imperfections as part of the family in comparison to Ed: 'And it made me so sad because it was like you didn't need me at all' - Judy also reveals in her letters that she still cares about her son. She reminisces about times when Christopher was small and she tells him 'I'm sorry, Christopher. But I still love you' - when Ed discovers that Christopher has learned the truth about Judy and Wellington, he shows remorse for his actions. He clearly cares about his son's feelings: 'Look. Christopher. I'm sorry' - Christopher travels to London in search of his mother. He hears voices in his head, one of which is his father's, whose words clearly show how he has cared for Christopher in difficult situations in the past: 'Stand behind the yellow line', 'Count the trains. Figure it out. Get the rhythm right' - when Christopher meets his mother in London, she is determined that he will understand her actions in leaving, signalling her desire to be a good mother to him. Perhaps in a futile attempt to justify her actions in her own mind, after neglecting her duties to the family, she says 'I said I wanted to explain to you why I went away when I had the time to do it properly'. Now she has 'lots of time', she feels able to break down the detail for Christopher in a way that he will be able to understand - later, Ed goes to London in search of his son. He confronts Judy when she questions why he hid her letters. He tells her how he has cared for Christopher in her absence: 'I cooked his meals. I cleaned his clothes. I looked after him every weekend; I looked after him when he was ill'

- when Roger Shears '*grabs at Christopher*', Judy '*grabs Roger*' in Christopher's defence. She wants to protect Christopher and, significantly, makes the choice to return to provide a family home for her son rather than continue her relationship with Roger
- when Christopher returns to Swindon with his mother, Ed does what he can to make amends. He tells him 'I'm very proud of you, Christopher. Very proud'. He clearly cares about his son and desperately wants to repair the relationship he has with him
- it is significant that, towards the end of the play, there are glimmers of hope that the relationship between Ed and Judy will be amicable and that a stable family unit will be established for their son. When Christopher is reluctant to answer Ed's questions about the exam, Judy acts as mediator and she encourages Christopher to respond to his father.

(A02)

- Language: Ed's concise lies about Judy's death, and refusal to answer any of Christopher's questions, show how he clearly struggles with the breakdown of the family relationship: 'Christopher, I'm sorry your mother's died', 'Now isn't the moment Christopher to be asking questions like that'
- Language: Ed uses simple language to explain himself and express his regret to his son: 'I know I lose my rag occasionally. And I know I shouldn't'
- Form: Christopher clearly struggles to cope when his parents argue, highlighting the importance of his parents having an amicable relationship. The stage directions show how '*Christopher starts drumming on one of the boxes ... He drums and drums and drums*' to block out their argument
- Form/Structure: the play fits into the genre of family drama and bildungsroman as it charts Christopher's development and growing maturity as he navigates his shifting perceptions of, and the revelations about, his father and mother
- Structure: at the end of the play, Christopher chooses to live with his mother in a bedsit in Swindon, showing his relationship with her has been somewhat repaired.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
7 <i>Kinder-transport</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the male characters have minor roles, but together they are significant in relation to the themes and ideas in the play and their impact on main characters. The male characters include: the Ratcatcher, the Nazi Border Official, the English Organiser, the Station Guard and the Postman - just before Helga sends Eva away on the Kindertransport, she tells her about her own grandfather: ‘“You are my children. You are my jewels.” He told me. “We old ones invest our future in you”’. Helga, clearly with the words of her grandfather in mind, sacrifices her life with her daughter in order to protect her from the Nazis - the Ratcatcher is sinister and menacing. At the beginning of the play, on the eve of leaving her parents behind and travelling to the safety of England, Eva is reading a book, <i>Der Rattenfänger</i>. The Ratcatcher is malevolent and sinister, haunting Eva/Evelyn throughout the play. He is the one the audience knows as the Pied Piper of Hamelin, who tempts children to follow him before subjecting them to great cruelty - the Ratcatcher is like a shapeshifter, becoming all the people in uniform who are unkind to Eva/Evelyn throughout her life simply because of who she is - the Nazi Border Official talks to Eva about the importance of her number. As a Nazi, he represents the evil and oppression of the regime that Eva has to flee. He tells Eva ‘Know your number. If you don’t, you might forget who you are’ - despite his official role, the English Organiser perhaps does show some sympathy to the children who have arrived on the Kindertransport, giving Eva his own handkerchief to dry her tears - the Station Guard acts in quite a friendly way to Eva before realising that she is not English. He immediately suspects her upon learning that she is German: ‘Got to look out for spies we have’. He says ‘Should’ve stayed where she belongs’ - the Postman delivers a parcel to the house where Eva lives with Lil. He lacks sympathy for Eva’s plight and jokes about Germans and the Nazis directly to her: ‘I thought everyone in Bosch Land learnt to march’ - Eva’s/Evelyn’s father does not appear in the play but the audience learns that he dies in Auschwitz. Helga tells Eva/Evelyn ‘I lost your father. He was sick and they put him in line for the showers. I saw it’. This serves as a reminder to the audience of the horrors faced by Jewish people in Germany at the time and of the reasons why Eva was sent by herself to live in England - Evelyn has separated from Faith’s father, with the indication being that their relationship has broken down a few years ago when Faith was 14. Although Faith’s father does not appear in the play, there are signs that he maintains a caring relationship with her, supporting her financially: ‘Dad sent me another cheque’

- the Ratcatcher becomes a symbol of everything that is feared: cruelty, loss of childhood and the dark side of humanity as well as Eva's/Evelyn's sense of guilt at having survived. Throughout the play, the fact that she is unable to escape the Ratcatcher, whether it be in the form of music or in its appearance as another character in the play, suggests that her life will be forever haunted by her past
- the lasting impact of the Ratcatcher, and his associations, on Evelyn are apparent at the end of the play: *'The shadow of the RATCATCHER covers the stage'*.

(A02)

- Language: the fictional character of the Ratcatcher uses threatening language to bring fear to the young Eva: 'I will take the heart of your happiness away'
- Language/Form: the Postman is presented as an embodiment of racism. When he enters, *'He is frog-marching, making a Hitler moustache on his upper lip with the index finger of one hand and doing the Nazi salute with the other'*
- Language/Structure: the male characters do not have names but are instead defined by their roles
- Form: the majority of male characters in the play are unsympathetic
- Structure: the Nazi Border Official, the Station Guard and the Postman all bear features of the Ratcatcher. Eva/Evelyn is haunted throughout her life by the idea of the Ratcatcher, based on her fear and experiences fleeing her childhood home.

Level	Mark	A01 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) A02 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
8 <i>Kinder-transport</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • hope is evident throughout the play. Not all hopes are fulfilled, but the play ends on a note of hope with Faith's intention to make contact with other members of her family in America • between 1938 and the outbreak of the Second World War, nearly ten thousand, mostly Jewish, children were sent to Britain to escape the dangers presented by the Nazis. Helga explains her reasons for sending Eva to England. She hopes that her child will be safe from the Nazi threat: 'Because any good parent would want to protect their child'. Her hopes are fulfilled in Eva's survival and Eva's new life with a child of her own • Helga also expresses her hopes that life will be much more positive for Eva in England: 'They don't mind Jews there. It's like it was here when I was younger. It'll be good'. Ironically, Eva embraces secular life and forgets her Jewish culture and religion • in recognition of the fact that she does not have much time left with her young daughter, Helga does what she can to equip Eva with practical skills in the hope that she will be able to use them in her later life. She teaches her to sew and, when Eva resists, she says 'There's no later left' • as Eva boards the train, she calls to Helga 'I love you too ... See you in England'. This hope is not realised as Eva's mother is not able to join her for many years and her father dies in a concentration camp • as the Kindertransport departs, the Ratcatcher music begins to play and the sinister words of the Ratcatcher eat up hope: 'I will take the heart of your happiness away' • the reunion with Helga that is hoped for when Eva writes to ask for work permits is not realised. The war prevents Helga and Eva's father from coming to England as previously intended • later in the play, when Helga comes to England, Eva/Evelyn confronts her over her actions and shows contempt for her. However, Helga is adamant that she acted in the hope of saving Eva: 'I was right to send you here, yes? It is good to survive. Is it not, Eva?' • there is hope for Faith's future when the play opens as she is about to embark on her own life journey by leaving home for university. However, Faith appears to regret her decision to leave home: 'It feels all wrong' • Helga's hopes that Eva will join her in America are dashed when Eva/Evelyn refuses to go at the quayside. There is an indication that Helga clings on to some hope that Eva/Evelyn will eventually understand why she had to send her away to England and decide to join her in America: 'I want my daughter Eva with me. If you find her, Evelyn, by any chance, send her over to find me' • there is some hope for a family reunion towards the end of the play. Faith expresses her determination to find and get to know her German relatives: 'I'm going to find out what everything means. Get in touch with my relatives. I want to meet them'. However, Evelyn has no desire whatsoever to do so.

(AO2)

- Language: as Helga and Eva are packing ready for the Kindertransport, Helga points out the watch and gold jewellery hidden in the heel of her shoe. She uses a metaphor to explain: 'We old ones invest our future in you'
- Language: Faith's name symbolises hope. As the next generation, she represents hope for a better future
- Language: when Helga writes to Eva about the prospect of getting work permits, she metaphorically expresses her hope: 'You have opened the door to a new and hopeful life'
- Language/Structure: the train represents hope as it takes Eva away from danger. The ship taking Helga to America, however, could represent loss of hope as it marks the permanent end of the relationship between Helga and Eva/Evelyn. The stage direction reflects the sense of finality: '*Sounds of a quayside. A boat is about to leave*'
- Form/Structure: the organisation of the play, overlapping characters from the play's past and present, articulates the idea of hope. Evelyn's daughter, Faith, is preparing to go to university and Evelyn is trying to give her household items to take. This situation mirrors the scene of Helga preparing Eva to go to England.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
9 <i>Death and the King's Horseman</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the Yoruba women of West Africa are a very powerful group in society and are presented as such by Soyinka. Their significance in the play lies in their desire to adhere to and uphold Yoruba values and beliefs - Iyaloja is the leader of the market women and is referred to as 'Mother' of the market. She asserts her will over a significant part of the community. She also upholds Yoruba values and honours Elesin for what he is about to do when he first arrives in the market. She speaks on behalf of the women: 'The voice I hear is already touched by the waiting fingers of our departed. I dare not refuse' - before his ritual suicide is to take place, Elesin sees a young woman and demands that she marry him before he dies, even though she is betrothed to Iyaloja's son. Despite Iyaloja's power, she feels she cannot refuse his request and the wedding goes ahead. The bride is silent and more or less an object to be given to Elesin at his whim - following the wedding, Iyaloja warns Elesin not to be turned aside from his sacred duty in the death ritual by an attachment to worldly things: 'Even at the narrow end of the passage, I know you will look back and sigh a last regret for the flesh that flashed past' - Iyaloja is significant in her complete lack of respect for, and dismissal of, the white colonialists who lead and govern the area, particularly when they try to intervene in the fulfilment of the death ritual. Iyaloja belittles Simon Pilkings, the District Officer, referring to him as a 'child' - when Amusa announces that he is at the market to arrest 'The chief who call himself Elesin Oba', he is scolded by one of the market women and he is called an 'ignorant man'. The women school him on the history of the tradition: 'It is not he who calls himself Elesin Oba, it is his blood that says it'. The Yoruba women attempt to stop Amusa and the constables from acting by using their bodies and voices to intervene. However, they are unable to stop Elesin's being put in prison - when Elesin fails to fulfil the death ritual, Iyaloja is furious, representative of the collective view of the Yoruba women and wider people. She berates him for his failure: 'Now look at the spectacle of your life. I grieve for you'. Iyaloja is unforgiving in her condemnation of him: 'Oh, you emptied bark that the world once saluted for a pith-laden being, shall I tell you what the gods have claimed of you?' - it is Iyaloja who brings Olunde, Elesin's son, to the Horseman after Elesin has failed to fulfil his ritual death. Elesin kills himself in dishonour. Iyaloja orders the District Officer to stop interfering with Elesin's body after his death, in accordance with Yoruba traditions: 'Since when have strangers donned clothes of indigo before the bereaved cries out his loss?'

	• at the end of the play, Iyaloja exhorts the community not to dwell on the deaths of Olunde and Elesin and to focus instead on the Yoruba traditions and beliefs: 'Now forget the dead, forget even the living. Turn your mind only to the unborn'. (AO2) • Language: the women speak with confident authority using short sentences to deliver their wisdom: 'The gods are kind. A fault soon remedied is soon forgiven' • Language: the Yoruba women encircle Elesin prior to the suicide ritual. Their words reflect the significance of this ritual through metaphor: 'For a while we truly feared / Our hands had wrenched the world adrift / In emptiness' • Language: Yoruba women use repetition to place emphasis on their message, for example when they repeat to Elesin 'We know you'll leave it so' • Language: the Yoruba women use insults to defend their culture and their rituals: '... official business, You white man's eunuch' • Form/Structure: the dramatic effect of the women, led by Iyaloja, emphasises the importance of Yoruba culture and its shared history • Form/Structure: the choric voices of the market women of the Yoruba tribe are dramatically powerful. They speak as one using first-person plural, 'we': 'we know you for a man of honour'.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
10 <i>Death and the King's Horseman</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • there are many examples of selfish behaviour throughout the play. However, there are also instances of unselfish behaviour, exemplified, in particular, by Olunde's decision at the end of the play to complete the death ritual himself when his father fails to do so • the play opens after the King's death. According to Yoruba tradition, the death of the King must be followed by the ritual death of the King's Horseman. Initially, Elesin appears to act unselfishly, for the sake of the Yoruba people, as he 'embraces' his duty as the King's Horseman, claiming 'We are already parted the world and I'. Elesin's role is important because it is his responsibility to carry ritual beliefs from the world of the living to the world of the dead, accompanying the King • in the eyes of the Yoruba community, there is no question of the King's Horseman acting selfishly by failing to complete his role. Joseph, the Pilkingses' houseboy, refers to the indisputable nature of the duty to the King: 'But before they can bury him, the Elesin must die so as to accompany him to heaven' • when Elesin sees the beautiful young woman enter the marketplace, he claims her for his bride. Iyaloja, as leader of the market women, must demonstrate unselfishness when she honours the wishes of the King's Horseman to marry the girl promised to her son • unselfish behaviour is shown by Olunde when, upon hearing of the King's death, he returns home from his studies in the West to show respect to his father, Elesin. Olunde knows that the death of the King also means the death of his father. He does this despite his father's having previously disowned him for leaving to study in England • Simon Pilkings is a British District Officer in Nigeria while it is still under British rule at the end of the Second World War. He does not make any attempt to understand the importance of Yoruba traditions to the local people. Indeed, when Simon and his wife, Jane, wear the <i>egungun</i> costume, they show no understanding or regard for its meaning, appearing to wear it only for the selfish reason of impressing the Prince • Jane does not fully understand how the story about the unselfish behaviour of the British captain, who sacrificed himself for the benefit of wider society, connects to Elesin's intention, and she is shocked by Olunde's view of his father's plan to end his own life: 'How can you be so callous!' Olunde responds 'I find it rather inspiring. It is an affirmative commentary on life' • Simon's decision to order the arrest and imprisonment of Elesin to prevent his taking his own life, without any regard for the consequences of this action on the Yoruba people, is significant in the play, as it results in the spiralling events

- when Olunde discovers that his father has failed to fulfil the death ritual, he disowns him: 'I have no father, eater of left-overs'. He believes that his father has acted in his own interests and not in the interests of the Yoruba
- ultimately, Olunde acts unselfishly, unable to 'let honour fly out of doors, he stopped it with his life'. Olunde chooses to take his father's place in the ritual in order to preserve the integrity of his family and the natural order of the universe according to Yoruba traditions and beliefs.

(A02)

- Language: Iyaloja is initially deferential and unselfish in fulfilling Elesin's wish to marry the girl from the market: 'Now we must go prepare your bridal chamber. Then these same hands will lay your shroud'
- Language/Form: the opening stage direction of the play describes Elesin as a lover of life: '*a man of enormous vitality, speaks, dances and sings with that infectious enjoyment of life which accompanies all his actions*'. At this stage, there is very little evidence that Elesin is ready to give up the indulgences of the living world to carry out, unselfishly, his loyal duty, and he appears to relish the attention and following his role brings as he is '*pursued by his drummers and praise-singers*'
- Language/Form: when Elesin sees the woman betrothed to Iyaloja's son, the adverb '*suddenly*' in the stage directions shows how easily Elesin is distracted from his duty as the King's Horseman to fulfil his own selfish desires: '*Suddenly, his attention is caught by an object off-stage*'
- Structure: the selfishness shown by both Elesin and Simon Pilkings causes the dramatic climax in the play
- Structure: Soyinka presents the contrast very strongly between Olunde and his father. Olunde acts unselfishly and immediately in fulfilling his duty, whereas Elesin draws out the process to fulfil his own selfish desires, ultimately failing in his role.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

SECTION B – Literary Heritage Texts

Question number	Indicative content
11 <i>Romeo and Juliet</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the theme of fury in <i>Romeo and Juliet</i> is prevalent throughout the play, such as when Romeo expresses his anger about Mercutio's death: 'And fire-ey'd fury be my conduct now!' Fury is almost entirely caused by the 'ancient grudge' between the Capulets and Montagues, and their ongoing feud, which often results in violence - the opening scene is a violent confrontation between the servants of the two households, clearly establishing the tone for the rest of the play. Prince Escalus is furious, and he warns Lord Capulet and Lord Montague 'If ever you disturb our streets again, / Your lives shall pay the forfeit of the peace' - from the early stages of the play, Tybalt's fury is shown to turn to violence: 'What, drawn, and talk of peace! I hate the word, / As I hate hell, all Montagues, and thee' - when Romeo gatecrashes the Capulet ball, Tybalt believes that Romeo has dishonoured his family, despite Lord Capulet's more conciliatory approach. Later, Tybalt is unforgiving in his fury at Romeo and he seeks revenge for Romeo's apparent disrespect. He demands that Romeo duel with him: 'Boy, this shall not excuse the injuries / That thou hast done me; therefore turn and draw' - as Romeo has just secretly married Juliet, he refuses to fight the furious Tybalt, Juliet's cousin. In response, Mercutio draws his sword to challenge Tybalt, resulting in Tybalt's mortally wounding Mercutio. As Mercutio dies, his fury towards the two duelling families is clear: 'A plague o' both your houses' - Romeo's grief and horror at Mercutio's death leads him to take revenge against Tybalt. In his fury, Romeo kills Tybalt in the duel - when Juliet hears of the death of Tybalt, she is distraught at what Romeo has done, and her feelings towards him are torn between fury and love. She is then angry with herself for doubting Romeo and with the Nurse for wishing shame on him - Juliet's mother, Lady Capulet, attempts to comfort her, believing that Juliet is mourning the death of Tybalt. Soon after, Lady Capulet becomes infuriated by Juliet's refusal to marry Paris, wishing 'the fool were married to her grave'. Her father is also furious with her disobedience, telling her that if she does not marry Paris, she can 'hang, beg, starve, die in the streets' - Paris is furious when he discovers Romeo at the Capulets' tomb: 'Can vengeance be pursued further than death? Condemned villain, I do apprehend thee: / Obey, and go with me; for thou must die'. Romeo responds 'By urging me to fury: O, be gone!' He kills Paris in a fit of rage - following the tragic deaths of Romeo and Juliet, Lord Capulet and Lord Montague reflect on the tragedy of their fury-fuelled feud. They are both mortified that Romeo and Juliet have become unnecessary victims, 'Poor sacrifices of our enmity!', and they agree to bring the feud to an end. Lord Capulet addresses Lord Montague as 'brother' and says 'give me thy hand'.

(A02)

- Language: Lord Capulet's furious response to Juliet's refusal to marry Paris is violent and extreme: 'Hang thee, young baggage, disobedient wretch!'
- Language/Form: at the Capulet ball, Tybalt's anger and desire to fight with Romeo is quashed by Lord Capulet, but he states: 'I will withdraw, but this intrusion shall, / Now seeming sweet, convert to bitt'rest gall'. Speaking in rhyming couplets, Tybalt sounds menacing and threatening while his metaphor about sweetness becoming bitterness is foreboding
- Form: the hot climate of the play's setting in the city of Verona, Italy, is in keeping with the hot tempers that blow up in its streets as the feud and the quest for revenge intensify
- Structure: Tybalt's killing of Romeo's friend, Mercutio, acts as a catalyst for Romeo's anger. Romeo responds with fury and turns from peace because of Tybalt's actions. Romeo's action of revenge, in killing Tybalt, leads to his banishment and to the problems that occur.

(A04)

- when Shakespeare was writing, society was largely patriarchal and the futures of women were generally in the power of their fathers. Juliet's disobedience in refusing to marry Paris is likely to have shocked the audience of the time
- Tybalt's name itself is related to violence, as he is called 'King of Cats'. At the time the play was first staged, these animals were renowned for their fighting and aggression, thereby accurately reflecting Tybalt's true nature
- medieval Italy was well known for its vendettas and deadly feuds, providing an appropriate setting for the long-running feud between the Capulets and the Montagues.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
12 <i>Romeo and Juliet</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (A01) • Benvolio is presented as a character with good intentions in the play. He is Romeo's cousin and is presented as a loyal and caring friend to both Romeo and Mercutio • Benvolio tries to keep the peace in Verona. In the initial brawl, he attempts to end the confrontation: 'Put up your swords, you know not what you do' • towards the start of the play, Benvolio reports Romeo's whereabouts to Lord and Lady Montague. He clearly knows Romeo well, describing Romeo's state of mind and his desire to be alone • aware of Romeo's sadness over Rosaline, Benvolio offers words of advice to him: 'Take thou some new infection to thy eye, / And the rank poison of the old will die' • Benvolio then suggests to Romeo that they gatecrash the Capulet ball, aware that Rosaline is attending, thinking that this would unite the couple. When it is time to leave, it is apparent that Benvolio looks out for Romeo and keeps a close eye on him, as he tells Mercutio 'He ran this way, and leapt the orchard wall' • following the ball, Benvolio provides reassurance to Mercutio that Romeo will uphold his honour by responding to Tybalt's call for a duel: 'Romeo will answer it' • later, when Tybalt is seeking out Romeo for a duel, Benvolio tries to avoid the confrontation: 'I pray thee, good Mercutio, let's retire: / The day is hot, the Capels are abroad'. He tactfully tries to pacify his friend's fiery temper, referring to him as 'good Mercutio'. However, Mercutio is in high temper and logic fails to sway him • Benvolio then tries to ensure that the rules of duelling are obeyed in the confrontation between Mercutio and Tybalt: 'We talk here in the public haunt of men! / Either withdraw unto some private place, / Or reason coldly of your grievances, / Or else depart' • when Romeo refuses to fight Tybalt, Mercutio is quick to take his place, despite Romeo's urging him to 'put thy rapier up'. Following Tybalt's fatal wounding of Mercutio, Benvolio breaks the news of his death to Romeo: 'O Romeo, Romeo! Brave Mercutio's dead!' He then warns Romeo of Tybalt's return: 'Here comes the furious Tybalt back again' • Benvolio advises Romeo to flee after he has killed Tybalt, recognising that 'the Prince will doom thee death / If thou art taken: hence, be gone, away!' • following the deaths of Mercutio and Tybalt, Benvolio is questioned by the Prince, who asks him 'Where are the vile beginners of this fray?' Benvolio is honest in his response, and gives a frank account: 'O noble prince, I can discover all ... There lies the man, slain by young Romeo / That slew thy kinsman, brave Mercutio'. He swears to the Prince that he is providing an honest description of the turn of events, 'This is the truth, or let Benvolio die', perhaps motivated by his desire to lessen Romeo's inevitable punishment.

(A02)

- Language: Benvolio's name, translated from Italian, means 'good will' or 'well-wisher'
- Language/Structure: Benvolio plays the part of peacekeeper in the play. In the opening affray, he orders the fighting servants to 'Part, fools!'
- Form/Structure: Benvolio stands slightly apart from the tragedy and is therefore able to give credible information and advice to characters, such as when he advises Romeo to flee after Tybalt is slain
- Structure: Benvolio is a catalyst in the plot, as it is he, with good intentions, who convinces Romeo to attend the Capulet party.

(A04)

- family links were generally considered important to the Elizabethans who would expect loyalty and close-knit bonds between cousins
- Elizabethan audiences held a common belief in fate, that the course of events was predetermined, which perhaps reflects how characters such as Benvolio are ineffective in bringing peace to Verona
- many of Shakespeare's plays portray intense friendships, including *The Merchant of Venice*, *As You Like It* and *A Midsummer Night's Dream*.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
13 <i>Macbeth</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Duncan is the rightful King of Scotland when the play opens, and he is presented as a morally good ruler. Macduff, the Thane of Fife, is a loyal subject of King Duncan, with an over-arching loyalty to Scotland; his morally good actions ultimately help bring an end to Macbeth's tyrannical rule • Duncan is depicted as regal and generous at the beginning of the play, praising the efforts of his generals in battle and giving Macbeth a new title in return for his loyalty. Duncan's fulsome praise and promises of more, in conjunction with the Witches' prophecies, lead Macbeth to have greater expectations • when Duncan reflects on how the former Thane of Cawdor betrayed him and committed treason against the Scottish throne, his inherent good nature is apparent: 'There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face: / He was a gentleman on whom I built / An absolute trust'. It is ironic that this misplaced trust also proves to be true with Macbeth • Macbeth himself points out that Duncan is worthy: 'Your highness' part / Is to receive our duties; and our duties / Are to your throne' • when Macbeth questions whether to kill Duncan, he acknowledges Duncan's 'virtues' and praises how good a king Duncan is: 'hath been so clear in his great office' • as a sign of his gratitude for staying at Macbeth's castle, which again shows Duncan's inherent good nature, Duncan entrusts Banquo with giving his gift of a diamond to Macbeth for his wife: 'This diamond he greets your wife withal' • after the natural order is broken by Macbeth in his killing of Duncan, Scotland suffers supernatural manifestations in nature, evidenced by the use of pathetic fallacy: 'By the clock 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp', 'A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawked at, and killed'. This reflects the belief at the time that the killing of the rightful, divinely appointed king would challenge the natural order • it is Macduff who discovers that King Duncan has been murdered: 'O horror, horror'. Macduff terms the killing of King Duncan 'treason', and he instantly recognises the act as a betrayal of the King and country, describing it as the 'Most sacrilegious murder!' • Macduff resolutely stands by his principles, remaining loyal to the morally good Duncan. He refuses to go to Scotland for Macbeth's coronation and is determined to uncover the truth, particularly as he is already suspicious of Macbeth: 'Lest our old robes sit easier than our new' • Macduff shows his resolve for justice for Duncan, and for his rightful heir, when he fights Macbeth and, important to the events of the play, it is Macduff who finally slays Macbeth. His righteous vengeance contrasts with Macbeth's tyranny when he says 'my voice is in my sword'. Macduff takes Macbeth's severed head to Malcolm, providing proof that Macbeth has finally been overthrown: 'Hail, king! for so thou art. Behold, where stands / The usurper's cursed head'

- as a result of Macduff's morally good actions, the ending of the play teaches the important lesson that good will always overcome evil. He declares 'The time is free'.

(AO2)

- Language: Macbeth vividly describes the state of the dead King Duncan's body by reference to precious metals: 'His silver skin laced with his golden blood'. Even after his murderous act, Macbeth's lexical choice serves to embellish the nobility of Duncan's character
- Language: following the murder of the morally good Duncan, Macduff pities Scotland and feels for its suffering. He uses personification to emphasise this: 'Bleed, bleed, poor country!'
- Form/Structure: Macduff is presented as a hero, first suspecting Macbeth's guilt, and then overcoming his own personal tragedy to defeat him and restore order to Scotland. He supports Malcolm when he takes the throne: 'I see thee compassed with thy kingdom's pearl'
- Structure: after the killing of Duncan, Macbeth and Lady Macbeth are damned and the castle has become hell. The Porter announces that he will 'devil-porter it no further'
- Structure: contrast is made between Duncan who shows his respect and appreciation for Macbeth, 'O Valiant cousin! Worthy gentleman!', and Macbeth who appears to be a loyal kinsman but is considering killing Duncan.

(AO4)

- belief in the Divine Right of Kings maintained the view that only God could appoint a king. Hence, in *Macbeth*, written for King James I, the divinely appointed kings, Duncan and Malcolm, prevail over the usurper, Macbeth
- at the time the play was written, the sun symbolised the king and sunset represented the King's death or overthrow. In the Witches' prophecy, 'That will be ere the set of sun' foreshadows the death of King Duncan
- when the play was first staged, treason was punishable by death.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
14 <i>Macbeth</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • the theme of control is prominent throughout the play. There are examples of control being exercised for morally good reasons but also examples of characters using their control to fulfil their evil plans • early in the play, Macbeth is presented as a powerful leader, able to control and command an army, even when outnumbered by the enemy. The Captain praises the valiant Macbeth, whose sword 'smoked with bloody execution', and graphically depicts Macbeth as a ferocious warrior against Macdonwald: 'Till he unseam'd him from the nave to th' chops, / And fix'd his head upon our battlements' • Duncan is the powerful, rightful King of Scotland when the play opens. He is presented as regal and generous, praising the efforts of his generals in battle and giving Macbeth a title in return for his loyalty. He has control over who is appointed as his successor to the throne: 'We will establish our estate upon / Our eldest, Malcolm' • the Witches appear to have control over Macbeth and they manipulate him throughout the play. On meeting the Witches for the first time, Macbeth is intrigued by both their appearance and the nature of their prophecies: 'What are these, / So wither'd and so wild in their attire'. He is instantly affected by the Witches, who give him the idea that he will become king, and Banquo comments that Macbeth 'seems rapt withal' • following his meeting with the Witches, Macbeth relates to his wife, Lady Macbeth, what they told him. It soon becomes apparent that Lady Macbeth is the dominant and more controlling partner in the relationship. As soon as she learns of Duncan's intentions to stay at their castle, she describes the visit as 'fatal', showing how she makes decisions instinctively • Lady Macbeth fears that Macbeth is 'too full o' the milk of human kindness' to fulfil the Witches' prophecy. Indeed, when Macbeth decides that he will not proceed with the plan to kill Duncan, she uses accusation and her powers of persuasion to make him reconsider: 'When you durst do it, then you were a man'. She then controls her husband by planning the murder of Duncan: 'Leave all the rest to me' • even after Duncan's murder, it is Lady Macbeth in control as Macbeth relies on her to return the daggers and to be the pillar of strength in their relationship. She also tries to cover up for her husband during his outburst at the banquet, after they have become king and queen. He sees, or thinks he sees, the ghost of Banquo, but Lady Macbeth passes this off as a condition he has had since his youth • however, following the banquet scene, Lady Macbeth becomes increasingly isolated from her husband. Macbeth changes his response to fear and it appears to empower him, driving him to further tyranny: 'My strange and self-abuse / Is the initiate fear, that wants hard use. / We are yet but young in deed'. He creates a powerful hold on Scotland, and he is feared by his subjects and thanes

- Macbeth orders the murders of Macduff's family. Their deaths are evidence of the escalating power and fear of Macbeth as he tries to eliminate his enemies to maintain his position of control. Their deaths are reported to Macduff in stark terms: 'Your castle is surpris'd; your wife and babes / Savagely slaughter'd'
- the importance of rightful control over Scotland is shown when Malcolm tests Macduff's loyalty to his country. Macduff accepts Malcolm's claims that he will be a king greedy for money and full of lust, but it is when Malcolm says that he will 'Pour the sweet milk of concord into hell / uproar the universal peace' that Macduff despairs of any future in Scotland
- Macbeth's murderous tyranny and control over Scotland are only brought to an end by his own bloody defeat in battle at the hands of Macduff.

(A02)

- Language: early on, Lady Macbeth knows that she can influence her husband; she is manipulative: 'I may pour my spirits in thine ear'. She uses a simile and a metaphor to influence her husband's behaviour: 'look like th' innocent flower, / But be the serpent under't'
- Language/Structure: the Witches' prophecies to Macbeth at the start of the play are an important catalyst to his actions and the play's tragic outcome. Alongside his ambition, they influence his murderous actions: 'Hail to thee, Thane of Glamis!' / 'Hail to thee, Thane of Cawdor!' / 'Hail to thee that shalt be King hereafter!' They also trick him with the reference to Birnam Wood and 'none of woman born'
- Language/Structure: in the final scene of the play, Malcolm clearly assumes his role as the rightful king. He adopts the formal language of kingship, using the royal 'we' rather than 'I': 'We will perform in measure, time and place'
- Form: the stage directions depict an abrupt end to Macbeth's control: '*Macbeth slain*'.

(A04)

- the use of the Witches to control Macbeth's actions would have been seen by the audience as a bad omen, something they would have attributed to effects in the world around them: a failed crop, a dying child or a disease
- the role of women during Shakespeare's time was generally seen as submissive in what was a patriarchal society. Lady Macbeth's control of Macbeth would have been perceived as unusual
- Macbeth was written for James I in 1606. It is in part a cautionary tale to warn potential assassins or usurpers of the awful fate that would await them if they dared to seize control from the rightful ruler.

Level	Mark	A01 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) A02 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) A04 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
15 <i>The Merchant of Venice</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • there are different types of love in the play, including romantic love, love in friendship and love of money • at the beginning of the play, Bassanio has lost his fortune through profligate spending and he discloses his financial woes to his friend, Antonio. Bassanio then reveals that he intends to go to Belmont to woo Portia in the casket challenge, who he describes as 'In Belmont is a lady richly left / And she is fair', raising the question as to Bassanio's intentions in pursuing Portia • Antonio is presented as a good friend to Bassanio, and he is happy to lend Bassanio money. However, Solanio hints that their relationship might go beyond one of friendship: 'I think he only loves the world for him', perhaps suggesting Antonio has an ulterior motive in wanting to help Bassanio • Portia retains a strong love for her dead father. She honours him by standing by his wishes in choosing a husband through the selection of caskets, although she does express her frustration: 'O me, the word "choose!" I may neither choose whom I would nor refuse whom I dislike' • having won the casket challenge, Bassanio does appear to worship Portia, finding her very beautiful. He flatters her portrait when he sees it in the chosen casket and likens her to a goddess, which perhaps suggests that he is not merely wanting to win Portia for her wealth • some sources suggest that Bassanio is more romantically interested in Antonio than Portia but that Bassanio needs her for the money and social status. Even Portia recognises that Antonio is Bassanio's 'bosom lover'. During Antonio's trial, Bassanio expresses his extreme feelings for Antonio. He would give 'life itself, my [his] wife and all the world' to save his friend • the relationship between Gratiano and Nerissa is presented as one based on a combination of love and practicality. They have completely different characteristics but are drawn to each other by the circumstances of the relationship between Portia and Bassanio. On their betrothal, Gratiano sees Portia's maidservant, Nerissa, and impulsively asks Bassanio to request Nerissa's hand in marriage for him. Bassanio supports the match 'with all [his] heart' • Gratiano's feelings for Nerissa appear to be founded on his physical attraction to her. He tells Bassanio 'My eyes, my lord, can look as swift as yours'. Nerissa confirms her love for Gratiano when Portia questions her, and she seeks Portia's approval of their match: 'Madam, it is, so you stand pleased withal' • Shylock is presented as a man motivated by money rather than love. Indeed, his first words in the play are about money: 'Three thousand ducats' • love can be seen to transcend religion when Shylock's daughter, Jessica, elopes with Lorenzo, who is a Christian. Lorenzo expresses his feelings for her 'Beshrew me but I love her heartily'

- sympathy is felt for Shylock when the audience learns that Jessica has traded Shylock's turquoise ring, given to him by his wife, Leah, before her death, for a monkey. At this point, the audience sees a sentimental side to Shylock, as his angry response to his daughter's act is clearly indicative of his love for Leah: 'Out upon her! Thou torturest me'.

(AO2)

- Language: Bassanio uses romantic language to describe why he wants to woo Portia: 'she is fair, and – fairer than that word – / Of wondrous virtue'
- Language: Shylock vociferously expresses his love of money in the same breath as he mentions his daughter: 'O, my ducats! O, my daughter!'
- Language: Antonio, threatened with death, expresses his love for Bassanio: 'Say how I loved you'
- Language/Form: in Belmont, Jessica and Lorenzo compare themselves to famous lovers from classical literature, including Troilus and Cressida, declaring their undying love for one another
- Language/Structure: Portia's love for Bassanio is evident in her positive memories of him, which she discusses with Nerissa: 'I remember him well, and I remember him worthy of praise'
- Structure: Bassanio and Portia form the central romantic relationship in the play after Bassanio chooses the correct casket and wins Portia's hand in marriage. This relationship is mirrored in the love of Gratiano and Nerissa.

(AO4)

- love is set against hate as the Christian loathing of Jews and the belief in their avarice was widespread in Elizabethan times
- Portia obeys her father's wishes in choosing her husband because she honours his memory and follows the patriarchal social hierarchy that prevailed in Shakespeare's time
- some critics have suggested that the relationship between Bassanio and Antonio is stronger than friendship. Close relationships between men are a feature of other Shakespearean plays.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
16 <i>The Merchant of Venice</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the relationship between Shylock, a Jew, and Antonio, a Christian, is presented as strained because they are rival businessmen in Venice. Shylock's pursuit of his bond with Antonio is the main narrative strand in the play - the two men are presented as very different. Shylock is obsessed with money, placing as much importance on money as on the love he holds for his daughter: 'O my ducats! O my daughter'. In contrast, Antonio, a merchant of Venice, appears to be a generous man - Shylock's hatred for Antonio is clearly apparent in the early stages of the play: 'I hate him for he is a Christian'. Antonio also shows his strong dislike of Shylock: 'the villainy you teach me' - as a Jew, Shylock refers to money earned in money-lending as 'well-won thrift'. The Christian, Antonio, disdainfully refers to it as 'interest', serving to exemplify their contrasting views. Antonio incurs Shylock's wrath by doing what would ordinarily be deemed a good deed by helping debtors to pay off their debts to Shylock just before the interest is due - when Antonio's good friend, Bassanio, asks him for a loan so that he can pursue Portia, Antonio is happy to lend him the money but everything he has is invested in ships and cargo. Therefore, he reluctantly approaches Shylock for a loan. However, even when asking Shylock for a loan, Antonio says that he will spit upon Shylock and insists that there can be no friendship between them - Shylock appears to be kind by agreeing to offer Antonio the money. However, he uses the loan as an opportunity to wield power over Antonio. Shylock suggests that 'the forfeit / Be nominated for an equal pound / Of your fair flesh' if the deadline is passed, and Antonio agrees to the terms, confident that his ships will return. He does, however, see through Shylock's actions and refers to him as 'a villain with a smiling cheek' - when Antonio is unable to repay the bond by the due date, Shylock's desire to seek revenge leads to Antonio's trial: 'I'll plague him, I'll torture him – I am glad of it'. His hatred of Antonio, which results in his pursuing the bond in court, is a direct result of the acts of anti-Semitism that he has experienced: 'If I can catch him once upon the hip, I will feed fat the ancient grudge I bear him' - although Antonio berates Shylock for being merciless, he also fails to show Shylock mercy at the end of the play. When Portia successfully defends Antonio, he insists that Shylock give up his faith and convert to Christianity. Ultimately, Shylock's pursuit of the bond results in his own downfall. His life is destroyed by his punishment, 'You take my house', 'you take my life', and he believes that his fate is worse than death: 'Nay, take my life and all – pardon not that'.

(AO2)

- Language: Antonio goads Shylock by using derogatory language to mock him: 'cut-throat dog'
- Language: Antonio speaks with self-abasement when he considers his position at Shylock's mercy: 'I am a tainted wether of the flock, / Meetest for death'
- Form/Structure: Antonio, a merchant of Venice, features in the title of the play, which represents how the main narrative strand centres on Shylock's bond with Antonio
- Structure: Antonio shares the play's happy ending as he does not have to give his life to pay his debt. In contrast, Shylock is shamed and loses everything: his wealth, his religion and his daughter.

(AO4)

- Antonio is extremely biased against Jews. Anti-Semitism was widespread in Shakespeare's time
- many plays written during this period perpetuated hatred of Jews, through portraying villains, such as Shylock, as scheming and sinister. However, Shakespeare does show Shylock's softer side and how badly he is treated
- the treatment of Shylock allows the modern audience to reflect on the views of society at the time the play is set.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
17 <i>Pride and Prejudice</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (A01) • self-importance is particularly evident in the novel through the behaviour of Lady Catherine de Bourgh and Mr Collins, who are presented as having an exaggerated opinion of themselves. Other examples of self-important behaviour include that of Miss Bingley and, particularly in the first part of the novel, Mr Darcy. In the main, self-importance stems from position in society. Sir William's unpretentious behaviour, in contrast, helps to throw others' self-importance in relief • self-importance is shown through the character of Mr Collins as he is presented as tactless and pompous, despite living under 'the guidance of an illiterate and miserly father' and not excelling at university: 'merely kept the necessary terms' • as Mr Bennet's nearest male relation, Mr Collins will inherit Longbourn after Mr Bennet's death. In response to Mr Collins' introductory letter, both Elizabeth and Mr Bennet acknowledge how Mr Collins' manner and inherent stupidity are rooted in his adherence to societal formalities • his exaggerated opinion of himself is shown when he arrives at Longbourn to find a suitable wife and assumes whichever of the Bennet girls he chooses will accept without question. He is most surprised at Elizabeth's refusal, at first believing that she is just being modest • self-importance is again shown by Mr Collins when just three days later he is confident enough to propose to Elizabeth's friend, Charlotte Lucas. He believes the patronage of Lady Catherine makes him a highly eligible suitor • initially, Elizabeth and indeed the rest of the village come to dislike Mr Darcy as he appears standoffish and disdainful. He is judged to have a 'disagreeable countenance'. Mr Darcy's position in society makes him proud and too conscious of his standing. He does not initially value Elizabeth as she is less wealthy and less established than him, and his opinion of her is also coloured by the behaviour of her family, especially her mother • however, once Mr Darcy is able to put his pride to one side, he allows himself to fall in love with Elizabeth: 'Darcy had at first scarcely allowed her to be pretty ... and in spite of his asserting that her manners were not those of the fashionable world, he was caught by their easy playfulness' • Lady Catherine acts as a contrast to Mr Darcy in the way the upper classes behave, although her behaviour does bear similarities to his conduct earlier in the novel • the self-importance of Lady Catherine is evident in the description of her: 'Her air was not conciliating, nor was her manner of receiving them such as to make her visitors forget their inferior rank' • Lady Catherine's opinionated self-absorption is supported by the obsequious behaviour of Mr Collins, who treats her with much reverence. His prosperity is a result of the living of the Hunsford parish, and Mr Collins admits he performs 'the kind of little things which please her ladyship, and ... the sort of attention which I conceive myself peculiarly bound to pay'

- one of the functions of Lady Catherine in the novel is to exemplify Austen's exposure of the faults and airs of the upper classes. When Mr Collins and his house guests visit Rosings, Lady Catherine's controlling nature is apparent in how she is 'dictating to others'. She tells Charlotte how everything ought to be regulated in her family, and also dictates to her about the care of her cows and poultry. Furthermore, when Lady Catherine visits Mr Collins and Charlotte, she even finds 'fault with the arrangement of the furniture'
- the self-importance of Lady Catherine results in her expecting her orders to be followed at all times. She tries to intimidate Elizabeth into refusing Mr Darcy's proposal of marriage, believing that her own daughter is 'promised' to Mr Darcy, and fails to understand when Elizabeth does not comply. She tells Elizabeth that she would be 'polluting' Pemberley if she were to marry Mr Darcy
- despite being only a second generation away from trade, Miss Bingley shows her self-importance throughout the novel. She tries to impress Mr Darcy with her social status, and she looks down on those she deems inferior, such as Jane and Elizabeth
- the behaviour of Sir William Lucas is presented in contrast to that of other characters such as Lady Catherine and Mr Collins: 'though elated by his rank, it did not render him supercilious; on the contrary, he was all attention to everybody. By nature inoffensive, friendly, and obliging'.

(A02)

- Language: Mr Collins is described as being 'a mixture of pride and obsequiousness, self-importance and humility'. Charlotte disregards Mr Collins' disagreeable traits in order to secure marriage
- Language: Mr Darcy's coldness towards Elizabeth at the Meryton assembly is cutting and insulting. He is rude and dismissive of her: 'She is tolerable; but not handsome enough to tempt *me*'
- Form: the reader's first impression of Mr Collins is formed in response to the letter he sends to Mr Bennet. His behaviour when he subsequently arrives at Longbourn confirms the initial observations of Elizabeth and Mr Bennet
- Form: Austen's caricature of Lady Catherine signifies that a person with money and high social class is not necessarily a figure of refinement and good manners
- Structure: Mr Collins is presented as the foil to Mr Darcy. Whilst Mr Collins acts with impropriety and exaggerated humility, Mr Darcy is presented with gravity and propriety
- Structure: Lady Catherine's character contrasts with that of Mr Collins who treats her with obsequious deference. Her relationship with Mr Collins and his treatment of her provide humour in the novel.

(A04)

- Jane Austen's own middle-class background provides some context for her satirical portrayal of the upper-class Lady Catherine. Austen arguably uses Lady Catherine as a stereotype of all that is wrong with the upper classes at the time she was writing
- class was a very significant factor in Austen's England and much of her humour surrounds the differing social classes of key characters
- the novel was a relatively new literary form, which was becoming more popular, especially with young women; gentlemen often read to the ladies as entertainment, but Mr Collins does not 'read novels'. He opts to read from *Fordyce's Sermons* and holds in contempt the Bennet daughters, who do not enjoy them.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
18 <i>Pride and Prejudice</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Lydia is the youngest of the five Bennet daughters; she is 15 when the novel begins and is presented as the most similar to her mother, Mrs Bennet, in that she is silly, impulsive and frivolous. Throughout the novel, she is shown to be irresponsible through her actions and the decisions she makes • Lydia has no thought for decorum and enjoys flirting with officers in the town. The fact that Mrs Bennet lets her come out into society at such an early age reflects casual parenting, which, it could be argued, enables Lydia to act in an irresponsible manner • Lady Catherine de Bourgh is critical of the Bennets for letting the 'younger ones out before the elder are married'. Lydia attends balls without really understanding the risks that could be presented by rakish young men • Lydia is presented as materialistic, borrowing money to spend on fripperies, even things she does not like: 'Look here, I have bought this bonnet. I do not think it is very pretty; but I thought I might as well buy it as not' • Lydia manages to persuade her parents to let her go to Brighton with Colonel Forster and his wife. This proves to be a foolish decision. Elizabeth recognises the dangers in allowing Lydia free rein: 'If you, my dear father, will not take the trouble of checking her exuberant spirits ... she will soon be beyond the reach of amendment' • Lydia's flippant and foolish behaviour is simultaneously reckless and dangerous. When Lydia runs away, she comes close to bringing complete shame on her family. She fails to recognise the potential harm her elopement with Mr Wickham will bring on her family's reputation and how it could impact her own future prospects • Mr Darcy and Mr Gardiner, her uncle, rescue Lydia from the situation. However, upon her return to Longbourn, she is presented as oblivious to all the fuss she has caused. She breezes back to her family with 'easy assurance' • when Mrs Bennet fusses about Lydia's wedding dress, she misses the point that Lydia's behaviour has nearly ruined her and her family's reputation, as well as all her daughters' chances of marriage, showing a similar irresponsible attitude to that of her daughter. Instead, Mrs Bennet is happy for Lydia • after their marriage, Lydia writes to her sister, Elizabeth: 'It is a great comfort to have you so rich; and when you have nothing else to do, I hope you will think of us'. Even in her congratulatory letter to her sister, Lydia asks for financial help and for Mr Wickham to get a place at court, and income. (AO2) • Language: Lydia's boisterous behaviour is frowned upon in polite society. She is described as 'untamed, unabashed, wild, noisy and fearless'

- Language: Mrs Bennet is unable to see Lydia's irresponsibility, instead praising her for her good humour in comparison to her sisters: 'Lizzy is not a bit better than the others; and I am sure she is not half so handsome as Jane, nor half so good-humoured as Lydia'
- Language/Form/Structure: Lydia's letters are a structural device used by Austen to present the reader with her thoughts after leaving with Mr Wickham. Her tone is brimming with excitement and considering it all amusing: 'What a good joke it will be!'
- Structure: Lydia is at the centre of the most significant drama in *Pride and Prejudice* when she runs away with Mr Wickham. She is rescued by her uncle and Mr Darcy, who bribes Mr Wickham to marry her
- Structure: Lydia's marriage to Mr Wickham represents a relationship built on shallow physical attraction and short-term gratification.

(AO4)

- the law of entailment meant that women such as Lydia and her sisters had to find an eligible husband in order to be secure in life. Mr Wickham, as a member of the militia and an officer, was given some status, which made him more eligible for a good marriage
- at the time Austen was writing, elopement was a very serious issue. Both the Marriage Law of 1753 and the Hardwicke Act consisted of strict rules. Obeying these was expensive, hence elopement was a way of avoiding costs, but its effect on a girl's reputation was devastating. To live together outside marriage, as Mr Wickham and Lydia did, was even more scandalous
- Austen's Regency England was socially divided and class divisions were established in family connections.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
19 <i>Great Expectations</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Pip is initially presented as a young, innocent and unpretentious boy who turns into a bitter, snobbish and unhappy young man before finally maturing • at the beginning of the novel, Pip is presented as a terrified orphan. He suffers at the hands of his sister, Mrs Joe, as she uses violence and aggression towards him. She proudly declares how she raises him 'by hand'. Mrs Joe's actions are at least partly the reason for Pip's desire to leave home and become a gentleman • Magwitch's confrontation with Pip on the marshes is violent: '“You bring 'em both to me.” He tilted me again. “Or I'll have your heart and liver out” '. Pip is clearly terrified of Magwitch as he pleads with him: 'Don't cut my throat, sir', 'Pray don't do it, sir'. Magwitch frightens Pip into helping him with food and a file to remove his irons: 'You get me wittles' • Pip is shown to be unhappy following his visits to Satis House, ashamed of his class and his family: 'I thought long after I laid me down, how common Estella would consider Joe, a mere blacksmith: how thick his boots, and how coarse his hands' • having met Estella at Satis House, Pip falls madly in love with her: 'I loved her against reason, against promise, against hope, against happiness, against all discouragement that could be'. He continues to be fixated by his desire to impress Estella throughout the novel • as Pip becomes increasingly unhappy living at the forge, he begins to see the area he lives differently. He compares the marshes to his prospects in life: 'how flat and low both were' • in contrast, Pip initially has high expectations for London. However, when he arrives, he considers it 'rather ugly, crooked, narrow, and dirty'. Pip is so focused on pursuing his expectations he is unable to see the virtues of the environment around him. In London, Pip gets into debt, and he and Herbert Pockett are described as 'always more or less miserable' • for most of the novel, Pip's love for Estella is presented as a source of his unhappiness as it is unrequited. Pip's unhappiness is, in part, because of Miss Havisham's teaching Estella to torture men and 'break their hearts' • when Pip eventually plucks up the courage to confess his love to Estella, she coldly tells him that she has decided to marry Bentley Drummle, an upper-class waster who is abusive to Estella • having believed that Miss Havisham is his benefactor, when Pip discovers that his benefactor is, in fact, the convict, Magwitch, he is initially horrified. However, Pip's learning of the truth ends up having a significant effect on him and it helps him feel the emptiness of his social ambitions

- after being corrupted by what Dickens presents as the shallow values of wealth and status in society, Pip learns significant lessons by the end of the novel. He acknowledges how becoming a gentleman has made him ungrateful, ungenerous and unfulfilled
- having gone through his journey in life, Pip is eventually able to appreciate the beauty of his surroundings. In contrast to his early view of the area surrounding his childhood home, he notices that the 'June weather was delicious. The sky was blue ... I thought the countryside more beautiful and peaceful by far than I had ever known it to be yet'
- at the end of the novel, when Pip returns to the site of Satis House, he describes how there was 'no house now, no brewery, no building whatever left, but the wall of the old garden'. This could be seen as a symbol of a fresh start for Pip and Estella, and their chance to find happiness.

(AO2)

- Language: Mrs Joe, with Joe, raises Pip from infancy. She is an atypical motherly figure, as she is savage and violent towards Pip. It is ironic that the stick Mrs Joe uses to beat Pip with is referred to as 'Tickler'. The word 'Tickler' suggests moments of joy, yet in reality its use results in pain and fear for Pip as a child
- Language: as a child, Pip is shown little love by Mrs Joe. She uses belittling language towards Pip: 'it's bad enough to be a blacksmith's wife (and him a Gargery) without being your mother'
- Language: Estella mocks Pip for his common background and Pip is the victim of Estella's acid tongue: 'what coarse hands he has! And what thick boots!' She repeatedly refers to Pip as 'boy', to demonstrate her superiority to him, as trained by Miss Havisham
- Language/Structure: there is some ambiguity at the end of the novel. The fact that Pip merely refers to there not being any darkness, 'I saw no shadow', does not necessarily mean that there will be a happy ending for him with Estella
- Form: as the narrator, Pip has the ability to reveal his views on events and characters in the novel, which helps to demonstrate his unhappiness to the reader
- Structure: as a gentleman, Pip is no more happy or successful than he was as Joe's apprentice, working in the blacksmith's shop.

(AO4)

- in the Victorian era, there were many orphans who suffered, effectively outcasts in society
- in the original manuscript, at the end of the novel, Pip runs into Estella, by chance, on a London street. Pip finds out that Estella has remarried, thereby diminishing the chance of a happy ending for the pair
- it is believed that Dickens changed the end of the novel, somewhat reluctantly and influenced by his friends, to allow for some possibility of a reconciliation between Pip and Estella.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
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Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
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Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
20 <i>Great Expectations</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • loyalty is a prominent theme in the novel, including Joe's unfaltering loyalty to Pip. Candidates might also consider examples of disloyalty, such as Compeyson's betrayal of Miss Havisham • Joe shows loyalty to his family throughout the novel. He tries to protect Pip by warning him that Mrs Joe, Pip's sister, is looking for him to give him a beating: '... and what's worse, she's got Tickler with her' • Joe has a cowering subservience to Mrs Joe, and he remains loyal to her even though she is physically and verbally abusive to him. The memory he has of his father's abusive behaviour towards his mother prevents him from taking a stand against his wife • after Orlick attacks Mrs Joe, she reverts to childlike innocence. Despite Mrs Joe's despicable treatment of him in their marriage, Joe stands by his wife and cares for her, alongside Biddy • Joe remains loyal to Pip and supports him, regardless of Pip's poor behaviour. When Pip falls ill later in the novel, Joe cares for him and pays off his debts. When Pip asks Joe for forgiveness for the way he has treated him, Joe agrees without hesitation: 'God knows as I forgive you, if I have anythink to forgive'. With maturity, Pip regains his loyalty to Joe and continues to visit him, Biddy and their children in later years • after Pip helps Magwitch on the marshes early in the novel, Magwitch is loyally protective of Pip. Upon being captured, Magwitch lies to protect Pip: 'I took some wittles, up at the willage over yonder – where the church stands a'most out on the marshes ... And I'll tell you where from. From the blacksmith's' • having been transported to Australia, Magwitch repays Pip's earlier help to him by sending him money anonymously. This is significant because Pip's journey to becoming a gentleman is a direct result of Magwitch's help • Pip does not learn, to his shock, that Magwitch is his benefactor until much later in the novel. Although initially horrified that he has benefited from the money of a convict, Pip forms a friendship with him. Pip does everything he possibly can to bring Magwitch peace at the end of his life, loyally visiting him in the prison hospital. He brings Magwitch comfort by revealing that Pip is in love with his long-lost daughter, Estella, who is now 'a lady and very beautiful' • Herbert Pocket is a loyal friend to Pip. They first meet as children at Miss Havisham's house but become good friends when Pip begins his education with Matthew Pocket in London. Herbert shows Pip around London and provides support to him throughout his life, such as by coming to the rescue when Orlick plans to murder Pip. Pip secretly helps Herbert to obtain a good job and, in turn, Herbert offers Pip a job with his firm in Cairo

- it is Compeyson's disloyalty, in cheating Miss Havisham out of money and jilting her at the altar, that results in her self-imposed exile in Satis House. Miss Havisham is left emotionally distraught and bent on revenge. As a result, she brings up Estella to be cruel to men and to break their hearts; Pip is Estella's first 'victim'.

(AO2)

- Language: Herbert is a loyal friend to Pip; he is honest and open. Pip describes Herbert as having 'a natural incapacity to do anything secret and mean'
- Language/Structure: the clocks in Satis House are 'stopped at twenty minutes to nine', which was the time Miss Havisham originally received the letter telling her that her marriage ceremony was cancelled. This represents how Miss Havisham's life has metaphorically 'stopped', too, as a result of Compeyson's disloyalty
- Form: the character of Pip serves to show that remaining loyal to friends and family is more important than social climbing and acquiring wealth
- Structure: Joe is a kind and loyal figure in Pip's life, and his presence in it spans the entirety of the novel. Pip relies on him: 'Oh dear good faithful tender Joe, I feel the loving tremble of your hand'.

(AO4)

- Dickens is thought to have wanted *Great Expectations* to convey the message that ultimately it is one's character and not class that is important. Herbert helps Pip on his journey in discovering this
- family was crucial to society and large extended families were the norm. As Pip is an orphan, it would be expected that his nearest relatives, such as his sister and brother-in-law, would take him in
- at the time Dickens wrote the novel, divorce was unheard of for the working class. Regardless of Mrs Joe's abhorrent behaviour, Joe could never divorce her.

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Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
21 <i>The Scarlet Letter</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (A01) • Hester suffers persecution and is shunned by the Puritan colony of Massachusetts Bay for her act of adultery. Having a child out of wedlock was punishable by imprisonment, public shaming and eviction from the settlement • Hester is forced to wear the scarlet letter, the letter 'A', as a symbol of her sin and she has to live in a 'small thatched cottage' on the furthest outskirts of the village • the strict Puritan community see it as their duty to remove Pearl from her sinful mother, which would inflict further suffering on Hester. However, Hester is resolute in her quest to keep Pearl under her guardianship: 'she felt that she possessed indefeasible rights against the world, and was ready to defend them to the death' • she goes to Governor Bellingham's house to protest her right to keep her daughter, determined not to have to endure further suffering. When Hester is looking around, a suit of armour reflects an enlarged image of the scarlet letter: 'owing to the peculiar effect of this convex mirror, the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance'. This symbolises the fact that Hester has become consumed by the image of the scarlet letter • Hester adroitly uses her punishment with the scarlet letter to justify why she should be allowed to keep her daughter under her care. She explains to Governor Bellingham how she will lead her child down the right path in life, having learned from her sin 'this badge hath taught me – it daily teaches me – it is teaching me at this moment – lessons whereof my child may be the wiser and better, albeit they can profit nothing to myself' • Hester suffers from the burden of keeping her relationship with Arthur Dimmesdale a secret, despite her desire to be with him. As a result, she has to raise Pearl alone. Furthermore, Hester has to watch Dimmesdale's health deteriorate under the care of Roger Chillingworth, having promised her husband that she would not publicly disclose the nature of their relationship • even in her role as Pearl's mother, Hester is defined by the scarlet letter, a sign of her suffering for her sin. When Hester takes off the scarlet letter and lets her hair down, Pearl does not recognise her. Hester wants her to cross the brook to join her and Dimmesdale, but Pearl will only do this when her mother pins the scarlet letter back on and puts her hair up • Hester attempts to protect Pearl from the strict views of the Puritan community and shield her from any suffering. When Pearl wants to know the meaning of the scarlet letter, Hester lies, saying it is for the 'sake of the gold thread' • towards the end of the novel, Hester returns to the Boston community, the location of her suffering. She shows her steadfastness when she goes back to live in her little cottage on the outskirts of the village

- Hester spends her time doing charity work, helping women, particularly 'in the continually recurring trials of wounded, wasted, wronged, misplaced or erring and sinful passion'. She seemingly uses her suffering for good, and she does not let the community's harsh treatment of her shape her life. Hester becomes an 'object of love' and is 'looked upon with awe, yet with reverence too' by the community.

(A02)

- Language/Structure: the women in the congregation at the start of the novel use the adverb 'always' to show that Hester will forever bear the burden of her crime: 'the pang of it will be always in her heart'
- Form: Hawthorne shows his viewpoint on the rigidity of society and its refusal to adapt, through the character of Hester. Her realisation that it is impossible to influence the ideas of society is apparent when she describes such a task as 'thankless'. Hester has to accept society's treatment of her
- Structure: Hester's public shaming and suffering is presented in direct contrast to Dimmesdale's secret self-punishment for his sin
- Structure: the title, *The Scarlet Letter*, comes from the red 'A' worn by Hester as a sign of her adultery and shame at having a baby out of wedlock. It is, perhaps, ironic that the product of Hester's sin brings her such 'pleasure'
- Structure: the end of the novel points to Hester's reconciliation with life. The reader could feel sympathy that it took Hester her whole life to change society's perception of her.

(A04)

- to bear a child out of wedlock in the 17th century represented a great shame and sin. Women who did were castigated by society, particularly by members of the strongly religious Massachusetts Bay colony, settled in 1630
- the true story of Hester Craford was inspiration for the novel. She was sentenced for fornicating with a man called John Wedge. Her punishment was a public flogging but this was put off until after the birth of her child
- Puritan values and society were of great importance to Hawthorne because of his ancestors. He uses *The Scarlet Letter* to both criticise and praise their beliefs and ideas.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
22 <i>The Scarlet Letter</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (A01) - the novel is set two centuries before its writing in the Massachusetts Bay Colony near Boston. This was a place settled by pioneers, surrounded by ocean and forest. It was a Puritan outpost where strict laws were enforced following rigid religious beliefs. Different settings in the novel include the marketplace, the forest and Hester's cottage - the first setting used in the novel is that of the marketplace. It represents the harshness of Puritan society as it was one of the main gathering places. The marketplace is a setting of rules, restriction and authority. It is here that Hester is charged with the sin of adultery and shamed in front of the community on the scaffold - the prison is a specific place described in the novel. The town was planned by its founders to be a 'Utopia of human virtue and happiness' but the necessity for a 'cemetery and prison' is noted. Its door is described as never knowing 'a youthful era' - Governor Bellingham is the strict Puritan governor of the Massachusetts Bay Colony. He wants to be seen as an important and powerful man within the community, continuing English customs in the New World, and 'he had planned his new habitation after the residences of gentlemen of fair estate in his native land'. It is here that Hester argues her case to keep Pearl. Later, he attempts to show his power and influence within the community when he is described as 'expatiating on his projected improvements' to his estate - the forest is a significant setting in the novel. It represents the opposite of the Puritan world of the marketplace. In the forest, Hester feels free to remove not only her headscarf but also the scarlet 'A' she must wear as a sign of her shame and immoral actions. The forest is also a place of truth – Hester is only able to tell Arthur Dimmesdale of Roger Chillingworth's real identity when they are in the forest. It is a place of freedom in contrast to the authority and rules of the marketplace - also, it is in the forest that Mistress Hibbins holds her witches' meetings. She attempts to entice Hester to join her at a gathering: 'Wilt thou go with us tonight? There will be a merry company in the forest' - Hester's cottage is another important setting in the novel, acting as a transition point between the marketplace and the forest. It is on the outskirts of both the town and the woods and can be said to represent Hester's position as an outcast, an outsider who struggles to fit in. Hester was forced to move to the cottage after being charged as an adulteress. It is a place of exile. (A02) - Language: the scaffold is described with emphatic alliteration as 'the platform of pillory', and as an 'instrument of discipline'. These connotations of punishment highlight the rigid and unforgiving priorities of the Puritan settlement

- Language: significantly, personification is used to present the forest brook in human terms in contrast to the inhumanity of the marketplace: '... it should whisper tales of the heart of the old forest whence it flowed'
- Language/Form: the forest is presented in ethereal and mystical terms: 'mystery of the primeval forest', suggesting something very old in contrast to the 'contrivance of iron' used to describe the scaffold. It has an enchanted quality: 'It was a little dell where they had seated themselves ...'
- Language/Structure: the rosebush growing near the prison door is personified by Hawthorne as an expression of nature; it stands as a symbol of hope and compassion: 'the deep heart of Nature could pity and be kind to him'
- Language/Structure: it is significant that a semantic field of hostility and barrenness is created in the description of Hester's cottage with its 'clump of scrubby trees' nearby and the fact that it was abandoned as it was considered 'too sterile for cultivation'.

(A04)

- in the Puritan society in the 1600s, the main roles of women were as housewives and mothers. As the colony sought to grow and develop, childbirth was crucial and women were encouraged to have many babies
- as a pioneer outpost, Massachusetts Bay Colony saw the need to humiliate and punish those who transgressed their rules. Both the prison and the scaffold were important symbols of this
- the enforcement of Puritan values is essential to the novel and is reflected in its settings. Hawthorne had strong links with his Puritan ancestors and uses the story and its settings to highlight the strengths and weaknesses of the Massachusetts Bay Colony
- the pioneer spirit of 17th-century settlers in America is a significant feature of the novel. The colonists of the town exist at a new frontier, leaving the old English way of life behind them and embracing a big new world of oceans, forests and vast spaces. It can be argued that Hester displays this pioneer spirit as well.

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Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.